dominantly Arabic in language and nationality, in which non-Arabic groups can rightly be regarded as intrusive population fragments. In fact, rather less than half of its people are Arabic in language or national sympathy. Turks, Persians, Cyprians and Jews -- not to mention lesser groups -- will not thank anyone for calling them Arabs!

The tie of the Islamic religion is more inclusive, but the unity created by this tie can also easily be overstated. The Sunnite orthodox doctrine of the Islamic world is fiercely rejected by the Shiites of Iran, Iraq and the Yemen. Both Turkish and Iranian nationalism, while accepting Islam as a religion, are violently opposed to all Pan-Islamic movements and reject Islam as the foundation of State and Society. The many smaller Jewish and Christian groups in the Middle East must also be counted out when the region is conceived as "united in Islam".

The greatest State of the Middle East, Turkey, has turned her back most firmly on her Islamic past. Islamic teaching is prohibited in Turkish schools. The religious orders have been closed and religious exercises forbidden outside the mosques. The Moslem Holy Law has been replaced by codes adapted from Switzerland, Italy, and pre-Nazi Germany. Arabic script has been replaced by Latin characters, and the Moslem calendar has given way to the Christian-Gregorian one. The fez (a brimless, truncated cone of red felt), imposed in the nineteenth century as the distinctive headdress of all Ottoman subjects, is still worn from Morocco to ~~Iraq~~ Syria, wherever minaret and mosque prevail -- but it is banned in Turkey. ~~Kemel~~ Kemal Ataturk, the father of the Turkish Republic, explained: "Nations that persist in remaining at the intellectual stage of the Middle Ages are destined to disappear from the face of the earth.... The fez sat on our heads as a sign of ignorance, of fanaticism, of hatred against progress and civilization. It was necessary to abolish it...."

It was easier to abolish the fez than to eradicate illiteracy, overcome poverty, and create a responsible tradition of democratic self-government. Three-quarters of the Turkish people are still illiterate. The number of schools in existence suffices barely to accommodate half the children between the ages of 7 and